Pamela Carey

The Pennsylvania State University pbc5320@psu.edu
Department of Political Science, University Park, PA
CyberCorps® Scholarship for Service Scholar | U.S. Citizen State College, PA | New York, NY

PRINCIPAL INTERESTS

Comparative politics, government repression, political violence, online extremism and extremist movements on social media, state failure, domestic politics and war, Middle Eastern regional politics, nuclear negotiations and proliferation, computational and corpus linguistics (semantic prosody), and quantitative methods

SKILLS

Programming & Data: R, Python, Java, SQL
Methods: Multiple linear and ordered logistic regression, GIS analysis (ArcGIS Pro, Field Maps)
Teaching & Training: Metacognitive learning strategies, training design, peer mentoring
Technical Support: Computer troubleshooting, IT support, Palo Alto firewall configuration, Windows Server and Active Directory
Software: Microsoft Office Suite, Adobe Creative Cloud, IntelliJ IDEA, PyCharm
Languages: English (native), Spanish (professional; NYS Seal of Biliteracy)

EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University University Park, PA
Ph.D., Political Science, College of the Liberal Arts Aug. 2026–Present
Advisor: Dr. Jared Edgerton

The Pennsylvania State University University Park, PA
Master of International Affairs, Middle Eastern Studies (GPA 3.72) May 2026
Thesis: *"Dividing the Indivisible: Modeling Nuclear Issue-Indivisibility Within Negotiations"*

Ordered logistic regression on 30 post–Cold War nuclear negotiations testing whether perceived issue indivisibility, rather than regime type or power asymmetry, predicts negotiation failure

Coursework: Research Design; Multi-Sector Quantitative Analysis; Diplomacy and International Relations Theory; WMD and International Security; U.S. Policy in the Middle East; U.S. National Security

The Pennsylvania State University University Park, PA
B.S., Security and Risk Analysis: Information & Cyber Security (GPA 3.76) May 2026
Completed concurrently with the M.I.A. through the Integrated Undergraduate-Graduate Program
Certificate: National Security Agency – IST
Coursework: Statistics for Security and Risk Analysis; Decision Theory; Risk Analysis; Intelligence Environment; Terrorism; War in World Politics; Cyber Forensics; Network Security

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Penn State Applied Research Laboratory (ARL) University Park, PA
Graduate Research Assistant, Walker Assistantship Aug. 2026–Present
Supervisor: Dr. Rebecca Anderson

- Conduct dissertation research within an ARL-funded computational linguistics project on semantic prosody, the evaluative tone words acquire through habitual use.
- Refine a Python semantic prosody detection prototype, reducing manual concordance work and extending it toward a multi-language tool for analyzing evaluative framing in media and geopolitical messaging.
- Analyze 18th- and 19th-century Gothic fiction and British newspapers to trace how evaluative meaning formed under the British Empire.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

The Pennsylvania State University — University Park, PA

The Failure of Ex Ante Agreements: The U.S.-Iran Nuclear Conflict through Rationalist Theory
Fearon's rationalist theory of war — Dec. 2025
- Identified indivisibility as the primary driver of intervention: Iran's sovereign enrichment right vs. U.S. "zero-enrichment" policy.

Political Exclusion and Repression in the Emergence of Violent Extremism
Cross-national multiple linear regression, 100+ countries, 2001–2021 — May 2025
- Found lower Polity scores significantly associated with higher fatalities per terrorist incident, controlling for GDP and stability.

The Impact of Leadership on Nuclear Armament: Russia's Stockpiles Across Presidencies
Linear regression in RStudio; Federation of American Scientists data — Dec. 2024
- Linked 14 U.S. administrations to Russian nuclear stockpiles, 1945–2023, to test whether interventionist policy provokes buildup.

Strategic Intelligence Failures Preceding the September 11 Attacks
Trafton's framework — Mar. 2024
- Assessed failures in threat recognition, interagency coordination, and information sharing using the 9/11 Commission Report, and evaluated reforms including the DNI and NCTC.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Penn State College of Information Sciences and Technology — University Park, PA

Student Director, Learning Assistant Program — Dec. 2024–May 2026
- Directed 40–80 Learning Assistants per semester, raising retention and recruitment through new training protocols and faculty partnerships.
- Trained Learning Assistants in metacognitive learning strategies to broaden student participation.

Learning Assistant, Java and Python Courses — Aug. 2022–Jan. 2025
- Taught Java and Python to 40+ students per semester; raised participation 25% through after-class group study sessions.
- Part of the team that designed and built IST 140, the first-year Python course; created readings, exercises, and quizzes and taught the pilot semester.

HONORS & AWARDS

Dean's List, Penn State College of IST (7 semesters) — 2022–2025

Order of the Sword & Shield National Honor Society, Penn State Chapter — Oct. 2024

David and Kathy Hozza Learning Assistant Award, Penn State College of IST — May 2023

Intelligence Community Center of Academic Excellence Scholar, IC Centers for Academic Excellence Program — July 2022

Armen and Claudia Manoogian Excellence Scholarship, Penn State College of IST — July 2022

New York State Seal of Biliteracy in Spanish, NYS Education Department, Office of Bilingual Education and World Languages — Apr. 2020

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

Penn State Applied Research Laboratory — Aug. 2026–Present
Walker Assistantship – five-year, fully funded doctoral assistantship

CyberCorps® Scholarship for Service — Apr. 2023–May 2025
SFS Scholar – two-year, fully funded tuition

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Local Campaign — Huntington, NY
Data & Digital Strategist — Mar.–Nov. 2025

- Developed a reusable web mapping template (JavaScript, Leaflet) that converts uploaded precinct-level results into interactive heat maps of vote margin with district-level detail.
- Applied the heat maps to analyze voter trends across Huntington's election districts and prioritize districts for door-knocking, poll watching, and committee outreach.
- Merged precinct and town datasets in ArcGIS into a unified geospatial file for regional mapping.
- Forecasted end-of-day turnout from bi-hourly early-voting data using linear projections to guide resource allocation.

Suffolk County Police Department — Yaphank, NY
Police Department Intern, Platoon Leader — May–Aug. 2025

- Led a 15-intern cohort as Platoon Leader, coordinating schedules and serving as primary liaison to department staff.
- Completed department background clearance and physical fitness qualification; trained across K-9, emergency services, homeland security, and patrol operations.

Penn State Office of Information Technology — University Park, PA
Cybersecurity Systems Specialist Intern — May–Aug. 2024

- Automated account provisioning with Unix scripting, improving the accuracy of privileges and activation dates.
- Assessed security policies in Splunk and configured a simulated Palo Alto PA-400 firewall.
- Resolved 100+ support tickets and contributed to threat analysis protecting 1,000+ network hosts.

Town of Huntington Government IT Department — Huntington, NY
Student Intern, Program Aide — May 2022–Aug. 2023

- Built the town's first IT asset management system using ArcGIS Pro and Field Maps, identifying outdated equipment to inform infrastructure planning.
- Piloted the town's first cybersecurity program, implementing Arctic Wolf endpoint protection and drafting IT usage policies.
- Supported IT operations across Windows Server 2022, Active Directory, and ManageEngine ServiceDesk.